

Rafael Padovani

Senior Front-end Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Front-end Engineer with over 12 years of experience building and modernizing scalable web applications using React, Next.js, and TypeScript. Strong background in front-end architecture, legacy modernization, application stability, performance optimization, and engineering standards. Proven track record of reducing production errors from 2,000+ per day to approximately 10, cutting deployment times from 17 to 2 minutes, and leading teams and architectural initiatives. Focused on building maintainable systems, improving developer experience, and using modern tooling and AI-assisted workflows to increase engineering quality and productivity.

SKILLS

Front-end: React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, Styled Components.

Architecture: Front-end architecture, scalable application design, technical discovery, architectural decision-making, legacy modernization, monorepos, Turborepo.

State & Integration: Zustand, Redux, Context API, REST, GraphQL, gRPC, Auth0.

Quality & Testing: Code review, engineering standards, Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress.

Performance & Observability: Core Web Vitals, Sentry, Datadog, PostHog.

Tooling & Delivery: Vite, Storybook, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Vercel, AWS.

AI-assisted Development: Claude and Claude Code for code review, debugging, technical research, and development-standard enforcement.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Front-end Engineer

Menlo, São Paulo, BR – Remote

Mar 2025 – May 2026

Key Contributions:

- Stabilized a legacy Next.js platform by identifying and resolving systemic runtime and code-quality issues, reducing production errors reported by Sentry from over 2,000 per day to approximately 10.
- Helped define the architecture and technology stack of new front-end applications from the ground up, using React, strict TypeScript, Zustand, Tailwind CSS, Auth0, Vite, and a monorepo managed with Turborepo, with a strong focus on scalability and maintainability.
- Led technical discovery for key architectural decisions, creating PRDs and comparison documents covering alternatives, trade-offs, and rationale, and collaborating with the engineering team to reach consensus.
- Established development standards and project conventions covering type safety, code organization, naming, DRY/YAGNI principles, and pull request quality, improving maintainability and making the codebase easier for both developers and AI-assisted workflows to navigate.
- Improved engineering and operational efficiency by reducing deployment time from approximately 17 minutes to 2 minutes, implementing observability with Datadog and PostHog, and integrating Claude-based workflows for code review, debugging, technical research, and automated enforcement of project standards.

Key Technologies and Tools: React, Next.js, TypeScript, Zustand, Tailwind CSS, Vite, Turborepo, Auth0, Datadog, PostHog, Claude, Sentry.

Staff Front-end Engineer & Chapter Leader

Linker, São Paulo, BR – Remote

Aug 2021 – Apr 2024

Key Contributions:

- Led the development of a scalable and secure internet banking platform using Next.js, React, TypeScript, and Styled Components, with a strong focus on performance, reliability, and user experience.
- Led the modernization of the legacy internet banking platform, transitioning the front end from Ruby on Rails to Next.js to improve maintainability, performance, and support continued product evolution.
- Designed and implemented a reusable design system with React, Styled Components, and Storybook, reducing development time by 70% and providing a shared foundation for future products and branding updates.
- Led a remote front-end team of 8 engineers, driving technical improvements, mentoring developers, fostering a strong feedback culture, and continuously evolving the codebase and technology stack.
- Led front-end technical due diligence before and after the company's acquisition, supporting technology assessment, integration planning, and alignment between engineering teams.

Key Technologies and Tools: Next.js, React, TypeScript, Styled Components, Ruby on Rails, Storybook, Rollup, Vercel, AWS, Jira, Core Web Vitals.

Front-end Engineer

Agile Content, São Paulo, BR – Remote

Jun 2019 – Aug 2021

Key Contributions:

- Developed and maintained the company's app store using React and Next.js, collaborating closely with UX/UI designers and developers to translate product designs into responsive, user-focused interfaces.
- Optimized the Next.js application bundle, reducing its production size by approximately 50% and improving overall front-end loading performance.
- Developed and maintained automated tests using Jest and Enzyme, improving application stability and reducing regressions.

Key Technologies and Tools: Next.js, React, Styled Components, JavaScript, Jest, Enzyme, AWS, Jira, Core Web Vitals.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Systems

FIAP, São Paulo, Brazil

Feb 2013 – Dec 2017

- **Capstone project:** Uber-like startup, from conception to programming and pitching, focused on connecting IT professionals to customers, providing express on-site work.

CERTIFICATES/COURSES

React - The Complete Guide, Academind

Next.js 15 and React, Academind

JavaScript Expert, Erick Wendel

TypeScript, Academind

LANGUAGES

Portuguese: Native

English: Advanced